summer of soul

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F/F, F/M

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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by applesauce6

Summary

When we grow up, we often leave our fond childhood memories behind to focus on the future. Not that there is anything wrong with that! The future is uncertain and holds a vast amount of possibilities for us. But, sometimes to unwind, it's better for us to look back at the good old times. After 4 long years of highschool, Adora is ready to go to college but wants to have one last enjoyable summer vacation before her next summers would be filled with studying and taking extra classes for the next semesters. So, she takes a trip down memory lane and comes back to a camp that she and her old friend, Catra, used to go together when they were younger, as a counselor. Adora meets new counselors and befriends them and even gets to take care of cute kids, but her mind always wonders to her old friend. Before she knows it, she's standing in front of Catra, who coincidentally is also a counselor for Camp Etheria. Unlike Adora who is eager to reconnect with her, Catra holds a grudge and makes it clear that she wants nothing to do with Adora. Summer is only a couple of months, would that be enough time for these two old friends to stitch up their torn friendship?

Notes

yay catradora fanfic! i missed them a lot so here they are! i really liked writing this fanfic it was super fun so i hope you guys enjoy it! yes i know it's like the start of fall BUT in my defense i wrote this summer camp au back in summer so LOL but yeah i'll be back next MONDAY the 11th with my FINAL fanfic (which will be catradora) before going on hiatus, next week i will tell you guys a reason on why i'll be going on hiatus but as if right now, i hope you guys enjoy this fanfiction!

See the end of the work for more notes

As we grow up, we tend to leave things behind- a picture book from kindergarten, a red toy truck that's been with you since you were four, an old blanket- even our childhood memories are left behind in hopes of looking towards the future. Not that there's anything wrong with that, of course. The future is uncertain, and having a plan is worth it- but sometimes, being an adult just gets so hectic and confusing. So much so that just *planning* results in a headache.

Which brings us to my point: sometimes, just *sometimes* , it's better to simply revisit the worn-down yellowing photos in the back of your closet, looking back fondly at our adolescent days.

"Bye Mara!" Adora said, embracing her guardian in a tight hug. "I'm going to miss you so much!"

The woman chuckled and patted her on the head. "You say that like you're never going to see me again. I'll see you in a couple of months, okay kiddo? You go have fun now."

Beaming at her, Adora nodded. "Right." She got out of the car and got her duffle bag and suitcase from the trunk, waving goodbye one last time to Mara, because she knew if she stayed around a second longer, the woman wouldn't let her go.

As she walked towards the gates of Camp Etheria, Adora looked around. She saw many children saying goodbye to their parents

who seemed like they didn't want to let them go for the summer just yet, while the kids just rolled their eyes at them, eager to meet their new friends at camp. Adora laughed to herself as she thought of her own memories when she was around their age. She then found herself standing in front of the camp's giant metal gates, gazing at the big words cursive engraved in the bricks: *Welcome to Camp Etheria.*

This brings back memories. It's been so long since I've been here, Adora thought to herself. *Maybe like… four or five years? Wow, I can't believe I'm back! You know I have grown up too since I'm not coming as a camper, but as a counselor! I hope I get some well behaved kids-*

Her thoughts were interrupted when she got bumped from behind. Adora looked down and saw a girl, roughly about 12 years old. She had short, messy black hair, and large brown eyes that were staring unimpressed at her. "You're blocking the gates," she said dully before walking past her.

Adora blinked. *She's a great example of who I don't want.*

She walked into the camp and saw a large crowd of children. Some of them got out of their shells and talked amongst each other. Others just stood awkwardly with their luggage as they waited to be assigned to their cabins. Adora spotted some other counselors and noticed that they were holding a piece of paper, which probably contained their cabin information.

Since there were a lot of people in this area, it was hard for Adora to try to find where she was supposed to go, but after asking some supervisors for help, she finally got her roster for her cabin and even got to meet her partner.

"I'm Glimmer, it's nice to meet you!" she said, sticking a hand out.

Shaking her hand, Adora smiled kindly at her. "Adora."

Glimmer was a short girl- *way* shorter than Adora- but she damn was she feisty. Even though she only knew her for a couple of minutes, Adora could tell that Glimmer was an outspoken person who liked to be in charge. Definitely the type of person you would like as a partner if you're supervising a bunch of gremlin children on the verge of puberty.

They met up with the four girls that they were going to be in charge of for the summer. There was Ivy who had long, braided, ginger hair and had pale green eyes that were behind round bronze-rimmed glasses. She was a loud and kind girl and seemed to be very popular with the other campers. Hazel, a girl with wild curly hair and dark tan skin, she was like Ivy, popular with everyone else, which wasn't a surprise, both of the girls seemed like giant rays of sunshine. Then there was Leah, who was the opposite of the other girls. She was a shy and timid bookworm, who had freckles sprinkled all over her dark skin and had her hair tied up into a painfully tight ponytail. And finally, Ronin, the girl that bumped into Adora in the morning. She had porcelain white skin, a messy bedhead and a permanent poker face plastered on her.

Of *course* with Adora's bad luck she *had* to get the rude girl assigned to her.

Ivy, Hazel, and Leah all seemed friends with each other before and were ecstatic to be rooming with each other for the summer. But then, there was Ronin. Earbuds glued to her ears as she listened to music, probably trying to drown out the sound of children laughing around her. Adora noticed that Ivy tried to include Ronin in with the others, but the girl always just stared at them with her usual poker face and turned around, not even trying to act interested.

Looking at Ronin who was staring ahead of the others, Adora hummed to herself. *Maybe I shouldn't judge her, she doesn't seem like a people person. She probably was forced into this camp by her parents to make new friends. I'll give her the benefit of the doubt, I bet she's actually really sweet if I get to know her! Plus, Ronin reminds me an awful lot of her.*

After they picked up the children they were supervising, Glimmer, Adora and four other girls started to walk towards their cabin to unpack and settle down a bit before orientation. "Have you been here before? You're looking around a lot," Glimmer observed.

"Oh," Adora said, "I've been here like every summer since I was 8 till 14 or 15. But I've never been on the Brightmoon side. Usually I'm on the Horde side of the camp. I can't tell if things look different or the same," she chuckled.

Glimmer smiled. "I see. The Brightmoon side and the Horde side are fairly the same. Camp Etheria just has those sides to make the camp games more competitive. Which is nice, I always *love* kicking some of those Horde scum asses!"

Adora gasped. "There are children here!"

Shrugging it off, Glimmer waved her hand. " *Relax* Adora, they're going to middle school, I'm sure they heard some curse words before."

"But-"

Wrapping her arm around her, Glimmer flashed a grin. "Don't be so uptight! The other camp counselors- at least the Brightmoon side- are *super* loose on the rules. Sure rules are there for safety, but breaking a couple won't hurt!"

Looking at the four girls, who were walking ahead of them and not even bothering to look back at her and Glimmer, Adora let out a sigh. "Alright, alright. Who are even the other counselors?"

"I'll introduce you before orientation, which is like a couple of hours away, we have time."

Adora nodded and before they knew it, they were in front of their cabin. The exterior of the cabin looked like any stereotypical

wooden cabin that you would find in the woods. The interior was pretty basic too. There were four bunk beds, one heater, one showeroom, two toilets, and a large sink to share.

Throwing her duffle bag on the top bunk of the closest bunk bed. Glimmer looked back at Adora and the four girls and grinned. “Alright, first come first serve!”

Then there was chaos. All the girls started to fight for the top bunk of the remaining three bunk beds and soon Ronin was the only one who didn’t get the top bunk. Adora couldn't really tell if Ronin cared or not since she just had her usual neutral expression. But, Adora did know that she wanted the kids to like her so she looked at Glimmer. “Give her your top bunk.”

Glimmer blinked. “No way, every summer I *always* pick this top bunk, I’m not going to change that Adora!”

Letting out a sigh, Adora walked over to Ronin and patted her shoulder. “Don’t worry, you and I can be bottom bunk buddies!”

“I honestly don’t care.”

Adora stared at her and her words slipped from her mouth, “Oh, shit okay.”

Glimmer snorted and bursted into a fit of laughter, the other girls following her lead. “What happened to no cursing in front of the kids?”

Turning red from embarrassment, Adora let out a sigh. “This is going to be a long summer.”

After getting set up in their cabins and unpacking a bit, Adora and Glimmer let the girls have a bit of free-time to explore the campus a bit before orientation. They also did that so they could hang out with the other counselors. And it seemed like the other Brightmoon counselors had the same idea since all of them and their kids were all hanging out together in the yard as they supervised and talked amongst each other on the tables.

“Hey guys!” Glimmer waved. “This is Adora, this is her first time as a counselor here!”

A girl with dark skin and dyed blue hair stared at her, she reminded Adora of Ronin since they both had the same *I don’t give a fuck* attitude eluding from them. “Welcome to Camp Etheria,” she said dully. “I’m Mermista.”

A tan girl with blonde hair and freckles sprinkled across her face beamed at Adora. “I’m Perfuma! Don’t mind Mermista’s negative energy, I *promise* we are not all like that!”

“I’m Bow,” Adora turned her head and saw a tall boy with long gelled hair, wearing a crop top with a heart on it. “It’s nice to meet you! I’m also Glimmer’s boyfriend.”

“It’s nice to meet all of you guys!” Adora smiled at them.

Glimmer nudged her. “That’s not all of us.”

“It’s not?”

“ *Mermista!”*

The girl, Mermista, groaned loudly. “Someone hide me.”

“You’re on your own dude!”

Turning her head, Adora spotted a boy with a hook mustache walking towards them. He had fancy hair for a camp counselor and was wearing a red bandana around his neck. “Mermista! I have arrived! Have you missed me, my beloved?”

She stared at him. “We had a date last weekend, Seahawk!”

Adora looked behind her and whispered into Glimmer's ear. "They are a couple too?"

"There's a lot of couples here. I mean, Perfuma's girlfriend is on the Horde side."

"Really?" Adora said in surprise. "When do we get to meet the other counselors from the Horde side?"

Joining in on the conversation Bow shrugged. "We'll probably see them during orientation. The rules are a lot stricter over there. Us Brightmoon counselors get to fool around a lot since Glimmer's mom is the owner of the Brightmoon side."

Nodding in agreement, Glimmer chuckled. "Yeah, she and Hordak are on good terms but they just have different rules for each other and we just like to compete a lot during the camp activities. Believe it or not, I never really came to this camp when I was younger, even though my mom is the owner. I got sent away to a computer programming camp during my childhood. Just a couple of years ago, I convinced my mom to become a counselor here."

Prying his eyes off of his girlfriend, Seahawk noticed a new face and gasped. "Oh my, oh my! Forgive me, my Mermista's beauty was just so *intoxicating* that I didn't seem to see you over there!" Adora chuckled nervously and shrugged it off. "My name is Seahawk! And yours?"

“Adora,” she smiled, shaking the boy’s hand. “It’s nice to meet you!”

The group continued to talk to each other, well except Adora, she just zoned out as she was watching the children play on the grass. But after a while, Glimmer was bored and wanted to play some games inside the game room. “Frosta!” she yelled, getting the attention of a girl with short dyed blue hair who was chasing the other girls, since she was older than the rest of them. “Round up the kids! We’re going to head inside to play 8-ball in the game room!”

Bow nudged Adora. “That’s Frosta, she’s Glimmer’s adoptive sister. Since she’s 14 now, she’s learning to be a counselor in training. But Glimmer just makes the poor kid do all of the work.” He stood up and stared at Adora. “Aren’t you coming?”

“What?”

“To the game room,” he grabbed Adora by the hand and pulled her up. “Come on!”

Glimmer turned behind her and stared at Adora. “What’s taking you so long? Let’s get moving, Adora! I need to beat Seahawk at darts and 8-ball!”

Smiling that they wanted her to come, Adora nodded. “I’m coming!”

As she walked with her new friends to the game room, Adora thought to herself. *It's just like old times, back when I was a camper here. I wish you were here with me though, then it would really be nostalgic.*

After kicking Seahawk's ass at 8-ball and playing other games, it was time for the most boring orientation that Adora has sat through. It was just the Horde side's owner, Hordak, and the Brightmoon side's owner, Angella, welcoming everyone and going through the most basic rules ever.

"Welcome to Camp Etheria!" Hordak's low voice boomed through the room. "We are glad to see that so many people have signed up for this summer!"

Angella smiled. "You have already met your cabin and counselors. Be sure to listen to the instructions that the counselors give you. Not just your counselors, but *any* counselors. They are all certified for this job and Hordak and I trust them."

Did Adora really sit through the same orientation every year when she was a kid?

How did she do it?

Adora blinked at the thought and then found herself looking around, scanning everyone's faces. She didn't know why she was looking around or what she was even looking for. She was just… looking!

Noticing that Adora was acting a bit strange, Glimmer patted her on the shoulder. "Adora, you good?"

Looking at Glimmer who had a worried expression on her face, Adora nodded. "Yeah, I'm doing fine, why?"

"Nevermind."

An hour later, the orientation was done and it was time for the campers and counselors to go back and stay in the cabins while dinner was being prepared. Not wanting to go to the cabin just yet, Adora tapped Glimmer on the shoulder. "Can you take the kids back? I need to go to the bathroom."

Raising an eyebrow, Glimmer stared at her. "You're not going to leave me alone with all of these monsters are you? They're going to eat me alive! Plus, there's toilets in our cabin, just go there."

Scrunching her nose, Adora cringed. "It stinks in there though! There's no air ventilation!"

“I guess you’re right,” Glimmer said, rolling her eyes. “Make it quick!”

“Gotcha.”

They split ways and Adora wandered the campgrounds trying to find a clean bathroom. She walked past a bunch of other counselors leading their kids back to their cabins. She didn’t recognize them so she just guessed that they were from the Horde side.

When she found the bathroom, out of her peripheral vision, she saw a girl with bushy brunette hair walk behind her. She turned around. “Excuse me!”

The girl turned around and Adora felt her heart stop and suddenly her adrenaline spiked.

She had tan skin, freckles plastered across her face and two mismatched eyes. One of them being light blue and another being amber brown. She was wearing baggy cargo pants and a tight leather jacket that hugged her body.

Adora could recognize those eyes from a mile away.

“Catra? That’s you isn’t it?” she breathed out, her heart still beating like she ran a marathon. “Catra, it’s me, Adora, do you remember me?”

Catra’s eyes widened at her but she scowled and spoke bitterly. “I wish I could forget.”

At Catra’s tone, Adora flinched. “How have you been doing?” Instead of answering, Catra just turned around and went on her way. But Adora was not going to let that happen and started to follow her, still trying to spark a conversation between the two of them. “It’s been a while, hasn’t it? I missed you so much. Isn’t it funny that we met here again out of all places?”

“Don’t you get it?” Catra yelled. She turned around and stared at Adora’s baffled face. “I don’t want to talk to you! That’s why I turned around! Stop acting like we’re friends! We aren’t friends! Leave me alone!”

Those words were enough to shock Adora. She felt her face turn red in embarrassment, she felt the strength in her knees go out. She wanted so badly to run to Catra and cry as she sobbed out questions. *How have you been all this time? Why are you pushing me away? Don’t you remember us? Please, can’t I be by your side again?* But instead, Adora just watched pitifully as Catra’s back disappeared in the shadows.

"Two-eyed freak!" a boy said, pushing Catra down and kicking her at the side. "Leave us alone you monster! Monsters aren't allowed at camp! Go back home!"

Catra cowered before the three boys that were mocking her just for having different colored eyes. Something that she couldn't control. She was furious, she wanted to punch them and hit them until their mouths couldn't work anymore, but she just stayed on the ground, listening to the harsh words they threw at her.

"Leave her alone!" a voice called out. Catra looked up and she saw a young, blonde girl push one of the boys to the floor. "If you're going to bully her, you're going to have to go through me!" Adora said, grinning smugly, showing off the gap in her teeth.

One of the boys frowned. "Adora, we were just playing around!"

"Yeah!" another boy said. "Take a joke will you?"

"Go away!" she said, pushing the boy again, causing them to just run away, their tails in between their legs.

Even though Adora was just 8 years old at the time, to Catra, it was like a goddess had saved her. A small, big forehead, blonde goddess with a tooth gap! But at the moment, she was the most beautiful person that Catra had ever seen.

Squatting down next to Catra, Adora stared at her. "Catra, are you okay?"

Catra nodded. "I didn't need your help, you know. I could have handled that myself."

"Don't be silly," Adora said, cupping Catra's hand in her palm. "If it makes you feel better, I love your eyes. They are really pretty and cool! Just like you!"

She blushed. "What?"

That just made Adora grin wider. "I'll always protect you okay? And I know you'll do the same for me. I look out for you and you look out for me," she clasped Catra's hand in hers tighter, "nothing really bad can happen as long as we have each other!"

Squeezing Adora's hand, Catra whispered. "You promise?"

"I promise."

Opening her cabin door and relieved to see that all of the girls were either talking to each other as they played card games or just sitting alone quietly, Adora walked over to her bunk and slumped on it. She was exhausted, it felt like all of the exhaustion

from the day just hit her. From the car ride here, the stress when she was trying to find directions to get her cabin rouster, the boredom she felt during the orientation, and the heartbreak she felt when Catra turned her back on her without explanation.

All of it came weighing down on her at that moment.

Leaning over the top bunk's railings, Glimmer looked down at Adora and grimaced. "Good down there? The bunks are actually pretty comfy, don't you think?"

"Yep," Adora said tiredly, "they are perfect to sleep the summer away."

Raising an eyebrow, Glimmer hummed. "You good?"

"I'm *drained* ."

"This was only the first day."

"I'm not looking forward to the others," Adora sighed dramatically and turned her body to face the wall. She closed her eyes, the events that happened just moments ago burning in the back of her mind and eyelids.

The next couple of days, Adora tried to pull herself together. She put on a smile on her face for the kids and just went on with being a counselor. But it was obvious that something was wrong with her. I mean, if you were just told off by your childhood best friend that you haven't seen in years, I think that would fuck you up a bit too.

Sitting on her bed and putting on some shoes to get ready for their morning hike, Adora hummed to herself as she tied her shoelaces.

"Adora! We're all ready!" she heard Ivy call.

"Be right there!" Adora yelled out. She looked up and saw Glimmer standing in front of her, a strange expression plastered on her face. "Oh hey Glimmer, do you want to join in on the morning hike too? When I brought the idea up at first, the girls didn't really like it but after a couple of days, I think they got used to it! Well, I think they did. What do you say? It's so refreshing and the views are fantastic!"

Glimmer stared at her. "Is anything wrong?" she asked, totally pushing away what Adora just said before.

Adora blinked. "No…?" she said, clearly averting her eyes.

“Oh… okay,” Glimmer said softly. Adora nodded but was totally taken off-guard when Glimmer suddenly slammed her hands down on her shoulders. “Just tell me!” she yelled. “Even though we just met, just talk to me! I’m a great listener y’know! I don’t want to have my partner all depressed like this! Who’s going to take care of the kids if you’re crying all day long?” she shouted. Taking her hands off of Adora’s shoulders, Glimmer sighed and crossed her arms. “I was getting worried, you know?”

Looking at the floor, Adora pursed her lips. “Ivy!” she called out. “Take the others to the field, looks like there’ll be no hiking today.” (“You got it!” Ivy said. “Stop complaining guys! We’ll just go on one tomorrow, come on, let's go to the field, maybe we’ll see Ashe there!”) Hearing the footsteps fade in the distance, Adora hunched forward and buried her face in her hands. “No, something has just been bothering me for a while.”

Sitting down next to Adora, Glimmer wrapped an arm around her. “What is it? You know you can tell me right? This is a safe space.”

“I had this childhood friend,” Adora started, “we would always go to Camp Etheria together when we were kids. We always had fun together- well we practically did everything together- but then later on I left because my foster mom got a new job across the country. My mom was trying to find a stable job, since at the time, she recently got laid off. So, to rack up money, she would work part-time in multiple fast-food places to just earn minimum wage. But yeah, when she got that job offer, we were ready to just go across the country, since it was a well paying job too. She still works there to this day.”

Letting out a sigh, Adora hugged herself, trying to cover up the sickly feeling in her stomach. “So, I left and I didn’t really keep in contact with my friend. Well, I couldn't at the time I didn’t have a phone because of my budget, and I didn't know her house number and I didn’t exactly know her address to send her mail. But I thought about her everyday and I missed her like crazy. I just didn’t have the time with my new life in another state to contact her. Which I still feel terrible about. And just last night I saw her! She’s a counselor at the camp too! But on the Horde side.”

Glimmer smiled a bit. “So you guys got reunited after all those years?”

Laughing bitterly, Adora shook her head. “Well, she wasn’t exactly happy to see me. She says we’re not friends anymore.”

Standing up, enraged, Glimmer clenched her fists. “Horde scum! How could she say that to an old friend?”

“She does have a reason to be mad though,” Adora said. “I didn’t even try to contact her when I moved away- again I couldn’t, but still. I was her only friend too, since she got bullied a lot, so me moving away must have really hurt her.”

Clasping Adora’s hands, Glimmer looked her in the eyes. “It’s not your fault that you moved! It’s not your fault that you couldn’t contact her!” When Adora just grunted and looked away, Glimmer pursed her lips together. “Look, we meet and lose friends, I mean, that’s just life! Sure you would want to hold onto the old ones, but

it’s also good to think about the future!” She grinned. “Damn! I sounded really smart saying that!”

Adora snorted and then eventually laughed softly.

Still smiling from ear to ear, Glimmer patted Adora on the shoulder. “My point is, don’t worry about your old friend, I mean there’s no harm in trying to reconnect with her, but I’m not sure it’ll be worth it if she bears all the hatred for you. Plus, you have me, Bow, Mermista, Perfuma, Seahawk, and even Frosta!”

Nodding her head, feeling a little bit better, Adora smiled. “Yeah, you’re right.”

Opening the door to her cabin, Catra trudged in and collapsed on her bed. Feeling eyes watching her, she raised her head and looked back to see her partner, Entrapta, looking at her with eyes of wonder. “Forgive me if I’m wrong, but you seem tired,” she said.

“I am,” Catra said, “I’m going to take a power nap, look after the girls okay?”

“Hold on! I’m so close to debugging Emily!” Entrapta exclaimed.

Catra laughed a bit. “You know, it’s weird, this summer camp is for like unplugging and to be with nature or some shit like that, but here you are, with a PC setup and everything,” she said, eyeing the girl’s bed.

Entrapta hummed. “Though I would rather be in a computer programming camp, I think a camp like this is good, since I get to explore and research different species that I didn’t get to before!”

Waving her hand, Catra hummed and buried her face back into her pillow. “Yeah, yeah,” she mumbled, “care to do that while you watch over the kids?”

“You got it!”

When she heard Entrapta close the cabin door as she left, Catra flipped over on her back and stared at the ceiling. She thought about the encounter with Adora just a couple of nights ago. Her eyes narrowed and she sighed, rubbing her temples. “Ah… fuck. You were always *great* with your timing.”

Stretching out her arms, Adora grinned to herself. *Finally, the camp competitions! A halfway point for the summer. I can’t believe I spent like a month in the middle of nowhere, surrounded by booger-infested monsters. Anyways, these camp competitions will be a nice distraction for me! Though, I will still have to see Catra, let’s just hope we don’t go against each other, that’ll just make things awkward and we don’t want it to be awkward! I can’t*

believe we've been in the same proximity for like a month and nothing has changed between us…

"I can't wait for this!" Glimmer said. "I can't wait to kick some Horde ass!"

A shadow casted over them and Adora saw a tall, muscular, bulky girl with platinum hair that was cut into a stylish undercut. She wore black lipstick and had a mean look on her face. Adora gulped. Why did Glimmer have to insult the Horde when a counselor was walking by?

The girl stared at Glimmer. "Were you just talking bad about us?"

Glimmer raised an eyebrow cockily and placed her hands on her hip to try to make herself look a bit more intimidating, even though the other girl was like two heads taller than her. "So what if I was, Horde scum?"

"Then I'm just going to have to-" the girl bent down and picked up Glimmer, embracing her in a tight hug, "squeeze your little life out with a caring hug!" she said in a sing-song voice.

"What."

Glimmer beamed at Adora. "This is Scorpia, I mentioned her before but you guys never got to meet officially! She's one of the

counselors from the Horde side. She's also Perfuma's girlfriend!"

"Yep!" Scorpia said, placing Glimmer down on the floor. "I go to my baking classes with Glimmer on the weekends!"

"Scorpia!" a voice yelled. "Get over here! We have to warm-up! Kyle- Rogelio- get *back* here!"

"Coming Lonnie!" Scorpia replied. "See you guys later," she said as she jogged off.

Seeing that Adora was confused on the exchange that just happened, she whispered into Adora's ear, Glimmer laughed. "We're actually all friends with all of the Horde counselors, we just make it seem like we hate them just to make the camp games more entertaining. But see, look around, we're all friends here!"

Glimmer was right, when Adora looked around, all she could see was the Brightmoon counselors and the Horde counselors all interacting with each other. But her mind wandered to one topic: Catra.

Where was Catra? Again, all Adora could do was just look around for the girl who was nowhere to be seen.

"Sparkles!" a familiar voice shouted.

Both Glimmer and Adora turned their heads to see Catra walking up towards them. Well, it didn't seem like Catra saw Adora, unless she was trying to purposefully ignore her, since her eyes were on Glimmer.

Rolling her eyes, Glimmer crossed her arms. "Ugh, Catra," she said in fake disgust, "showing up late like usual?"

"I call it being *fashionably* late." Catra shrugged when Glimmer kept glaring at her. "Slept in, couldn't help it, I was having a *great* dream of beating you Brightmoon princesses at the camp games."

Smirking, Glimmer laughed. "That's going to have to stay a dream for you, since this year, we're going to take the win!"

"Oh?"

Right when Adora was about to walk away from conversation, she felt Glimmer pull her back by the collar and the next thing she knew was that she was face to face with Catra, who was looking at her with wide eyes that soon turned into slits. "Because we have Adora! Oh, by the way, meet Adora." Catra narrowed her eyes even more and crossed her arms while Adora just scratched her cheek, wondering what wrong she had done to get into this conversation. "Anyway," Glimmer said, "we have a contestant to go against you for the rope-climbing and this is her!"

“What?” Adora said, her head spinning in circles. “I didn’t agree to this!”

“Oh come on, please?” Glimmer said. “You look like a fucking spider-monkey on the rock climbing wall! If you represent Brightmoon for the rope-climbing, we can win against Catra and her *freakishly* cat-like skills!”

Letting out a sigh, Catra waved and walked away. “Oh please, let’s see you try,” she huffed under her breath.

This might finally get you closer to Catra so you guys can talk to each other, Adora thought to herself. “Fine,” she said, “I’ll do it.”

Glimmer cheered. “Yes! Yes, yes, yes, yes!”

Glancing over at her, Adora nudged her. “But anyway, you know Catra?”

She nodded. “Yeah, of course I do. We’ve known each other for a while. Why?”

“That’s the friend I was talking about!” Adora hissed.

Glimmer blinked and then realized what her friend meant. “Oh! I forgot about that!” Adora facepalmed and Glimmer cringed. “That was a bit awkward, wasn't it?”

“You have no idea…”

Adora looked around and watched as the Brightmoon and Horde counselors and campers came together after competing against each other. There was a 500 meter rally race, three legged race, a little wrestling match, cup pong without the beer, team dodgeball, capture the flag and now it was time for the last activity, rope-climbing.

So far the Brightmoon side has won the three legged race, cup pong, and team dodgeball and the Horde side has won the the more physical activities such as the 500 meter really race, the small wrestling match, and capture the flag

Patting Adora on the shoulder, Glimmer stared at her with intense eyes. “No pressure,” she said, smearing the dirt off of her cheek, “but if you don’t win the rope-climbing we lose the camp games for like the fifth year in a row. But *if* you win, we finally get a win against the Horde. But again, no pressure.”

“Correct me if I’m wrong,” Adora siad, “but it does feel like you’re putting a lot of pressure on me.”

Bow grinned. “It’s okay, you got this! *Sure* , Catra is undefeated with rope-climbing, but who knows, maybe she’ll be defeated now!”

Groaning, Mermista shrugged. “Just do whatever, this is all useless anyways.”

“Don’t be negative Mermista!” Perfuma scolded her. “You’re going to spread that energy over to Adora and she needs to keep her yellow aura- well- yellow!”

Seahawk grunted. “I don’t see why I can’t compete in rope-climbing.”

“Last year, you got rope burns and started to cry when you got hit in the face with a plastic ball by a 9 year old.”

“Again, I don’t see why I can’t compete in rope-climbing.”

Adora felt someone tug on her sleeve and looked down to see Frosta. “You better win this,” she said, a bit threateningly. “I bet 20 bucks on you!”

It’s nice to know that I’m worth 20 bucks, Adora thought. “I’ll try my best!” she said before she went over to the wall and held onto the 30 feet rope. The girl gulped. *I have to climb up this, ring the bell, and climb down while Catra’s campers throw plastic balls at*

me. This is fine, you were a soccer champion back in highschool, you can handle this. Let's just hope all of my training doesn't go to waste!

"I still can't believe they picked you to do this event," Catra muttered as she stood beside Adora to get ready for the race. "Rookie move."

"I always wanted to do this event whenever I saw our counselors do it," Adora said. "Even though it's my first time, I'm going to beat you!"

Catra looked over at her and smirked. "Oh yeah?"

"Hell yeah," Adora smirked, "you know how many times I did this in CrossFit?" Catra raised an eyebrow at her. "Like one time, but the point still stands."

The other girl snorted and rolled her eyes. *"When the whistle blows the race will begin!"* Hordak announced on the microphone. *"The winner of this event will determine the winner of the camp games!"*

Clenching the thick rope in her hand, Adora took a deep breath and when the whistle was blown both her and Catra started to climb the rope.

It was anguishing. Was 30 feet really this long? Adora could feel her triceps flex as she ascended the rope. Every part of her body was burning, her abs were screaming in pain, but she grit her teeth and endured it. The skin on her palm was burning every time she moved up the rope. It didn't help that the campers were throwing plastic balls at them either, it totally was throwing her balance off.

She kept going and an eternity later, she reached the top and rang the bell. She forgot if Catra rang the bell before her, everything was a blur to her at the moment, all she knew was that she had to get down.

Going down is easier then going up and before she knew it her foot reached the ground and she collapsed, exhausted. Adora could hear cheering, but she didn't know why, she looked up and saw that Catra was still climbing down the rope.

She had won!

Using all of her strength she got up and hugged her campers and then her friends, who were laughing wildly, still in disbelief that she had just won!

"Good job," Catra said, punching Adora lightly on the shoulder.

Turning around, Adora beamed at her. "Wow, you climbed really fast though! You do this event all the time? That's amazing! I

could never, this was just beginner's luck! I have to thank my old highschool soccer coach for pushing me during conditioning! Thank you Ms. Hope!”

Catra nodded and even managed to smile, it was like she had forgotten that she had a grudge against Adora for a moment and was reminded of the old memories between the both of them But that moment was cut short since once she realized that she had possibly opened a door for Adora, so Catra turned and walked away. Like Catra, Adora saw the door of opportunity and wasn’t going to let that go to waste. Her strength immediately came back and she matched Catra’s pace, walking alongside her.

“It’s been ages since we have done anything together,” Adora said. “That really just gave me flashbacks from years ago, don’t you feel the same? I mean like we were an amazing team when it came to the 500 meter run! Oh and don’t even talk to me about capture the flag, we were the best duo out there! Hell, remember when you saved me from getting out during dodgeball? Iconic.”

Catra stared at her. “Me congratulating you on winning was not an invitation for you to just talk to me, that’s just me being a good sport. Now leave me alone!”

Not wanting Catra to leave again, Adora stared at her, a bit angry that she keeps being pushed away. “Why? Can’t you see that I’m trying to do my best to reconnect with you? For the last month I’ve been trying to! Why can’t you do the same?”

“Why would I want to reconnect with someone who cut me out of their life years ago? Just so you could have another chance to leave me?” Catra shouted. She looked over at Adora, her eyes glistening with unwanted tears. “Why would you do that to me? *How* could you do that to me? We were best friends! Don’t you remember the promise we made?”

Catra let out a bitter laugh. “Like hell you do, you probably forgot all about me and everything when you got onto a plane ride towards your new life.” When Adora didn’t respond since she was too shocked, Catra scoffed, kicking the dirt underneath her foot as she walked away, forcing Adora to face the dreadful view of her back walking away.

I know it’s been a couple of days, Adora thought to herself, *but I still can’t get what happened at the camp games out of my mind. I really fucked it up. Of course that’s why she doesn’t want to talk to me again. It’s valid too. If that’s her wish though, I should respect it, shouldn’t I?* Adora shifted on her bed. *Now Glimmer took the girls out to play, I told her I was feeling sick- which wasn't completely a lie- so I’d be staying behind this time. I love spending time with the girls, they are always fun, but I haven’t really gotten the chance to just have some alone time and just think.*

In the midst of her thoughts, Adora heard the toilet flush, she sat up from her bed. “Who’s there?” she called out. *A ghost? No way right? Please don’t be a ghost, I can’t handle this right now.* Instead of seeing a terrifying woman wearing a white dress that was stained with blood, she saw a girl peek her head out. Adora

blinked. “Ronin, what are you doing here? Why didn’t you go with the others?”

“I could ask you the same,” the girl said as she washed her hands in the sink.

I see she’s as bold as ever. Just like Catra, I got no progress with getting to know Ronin unlike the other campers who love me.

“I asked first,” Adora said, matching her energy.

Walking over to her bunk, which was across from Adora's, Ronin sighed as she sat down. “I don’t want to. I got in a fight with Ivy and I’m sure she hates me now.”

Adora stared at her. *Ivy’s mad at Ronin? Ivy’s always with Ronin since Ronin gets bullied for being quiet and a loner. The two of them are always seen together and playing with each other. Well, it looks like Ivy’s the talker and Ronin’s the listener.* “Do you want to tell me what happened?”

Ronin hesitated a bit but then nodded. “For a couple of days, I’ve been ignoring her but I can’t help it! Every time she’s near me, my stomach gets all queasy and all weird and I feel sick! When I was ignoring her, she kept asking me dumb questions like why was I ignoring her? I felt really bad so I just told her how I felt whenever I'm around her, how she made my stomach feel weird and sick. But when I told her she got really sad and mad- I think-

and just ran off crying like a baby." She stared at the ground. "I know I told her to leave me alone, but the days are so boring when I don't talk to her, it's not the same and now she's just hanging out with Ashe all the time. Ugh… I can't stand Ashe. She thinks she's so great."

Seeing the girl's tinted cheeks when she talked about Ivy and how her tone rose when she spoke about Ashe, Adora snorted. "Sounds like you have a crush."

Immediately looking up, Ronin's usually pale, white skin was flushed a bright red. "No! I don't have a crush on Ivy! I just get really nervous around her and whenever she smiles my heart feels like it's about to burst! And whenever she gets near me and our hands touch, I always pull my hand back because I know that if we're too close I might hold it!" When Ronin saw Adora's obnoxious smirk, she groaned and buried her face in her hands.

"It's okay," Adora said, kneeling down in front of her and patting her on the shoulder. "Let me give you some words of advice: you should go talk to her, before things get messy and you regret it later on. Be truthful to her, just tell her everything- even about your crush on her- if she doesn't forgive you, it's okay, you did your part and that's all that matters. At least you're giving her some closure. You don't want to make the mistake of completely cutting off an amazing friendship, trust me."

Ronin blinked. "What if she thinks I'm weird for liking her? What if she likes Ashe? I mean- why would she like me? She probably thinks I'm a chore, since she always saves me from the mean kids on the field."

Smiling softly at the girl, Adora hugged her. “Don’t worry, I’ve seen the way she looks at you. You’re all fine. Ashe has nothing on you.”

Looking away, still blushing, Ronin muttered. “Sorry for being mean to you in the beginning of camp by the way. I’m not really a people person and I just say whatever’s on my mind without thinking.”

Patting Ronin again on the back, Adora laughed. “It’s okay, I get it, I had a fr-” she swallowed and shook her head, “a person in my life that was like you.”

“Is it that Catra girl?” Adora stared at her, confused that Catra’s name came out of her mouth. Ronin just shrugged. “I heard you and Glimmer talk about her sometimes, plus she’s a pretty popular counselor too, she bought ice cream for everyone before and everyone talks to her, even the Brightmoon kids.” Standing up from the bed, Ronin flashed a small smile at Adora. “Thanks for the advice though, I’m going to find Ivy now.”

“Good luck, you can do it.”

Nodding her head, Ronin was about to leave the cabin but stopped. “Also, about the Catra girl, just follow your own advice, it seemed like you were mostly talking about her anyway.”

Sitting around a bonfire with all of the other counselors, the Horde ones included, Adora just watched her marshmallow cook as she listened to the chatter around her. She switched her focus from her marshmallow to Catra who was sitting across from her, just talking to her other friends.

She sighed. *I'm thankful that the group doesn't know about my history with Catra, since that would just make things ten times more awkward, so they just think we don't talk to each other because we don't know each other well. I don't feel that awkward this time when Catra is here, maybe that's because my other friends are with me.*

"Also, about the Catra girl," Ronin's voice echoed through Adora's head, " *just follow your own advice, it seemed like you were mostly talking about her anyway."*

Pinching the bridge of her nose together, Adora groaned. *A fucking 12 year old was able to make amends with her crush, why can't I? I mean literally after I talked to Ronin, she and Ivy have been all lovey-dovey with each other- reminds me of Catra and I when we were younger.*

Out of the corner of her peripheral vision, she saw Catra stand up and start to walk away from the bonfire. Adora swallowed. *Where's she going?* She looked over at Glimmer. "Take care of my marshmallow for me- going to the bathroom!" she said hurryingly,

running off towards Catra even before she heard Glimmer's response.

Why does she walk so fucking fast? Adora thought as she ran in the direction Catra walked away. Spotting the girl walking under a lamp, she sprinted over to her and caught her by the shoulder. "Catra!"

Catra turned around, her eyes wide in surprise. "Adora, what are you-"

"Can we talk… please?"

To her surprise, Catra nodded.

"What's up?" Catra said, sitting down on a bench underneath a lamp.

Adora shrugged. "I just wanted to let you know that I'm going to be going back to town for college. I'm going to Alwyn Tech."

"Oh shit, really?" Adora nodded and Catra snorted, their old chemistry seemingly to have never left them. "You were always the smart one." They sat in silence until Catra spoke up. "Well, I'm not going to Alwyn Tech, but I am going to Mystacor University."

Smiling, Adora nudged the girl. “Hey, that’s only a couple of miles away from my school, maybe we could catch up more like this.”

“Maybe we should.”

Glancing at Catra, Adora hummed. “So… what are you majoring in?”

“I’m going to be a law student.”

“Well, you always liked arguing, remember when you cursed at Hordak when we were younger? I’m surprised he gave you a job as a counselor even after that!”

Catra laughed. “Oh man, I remember that! You’re so right!” She quickly looked at Adora. “What about you? What are you majoring in?”

“Well, I really wanna be a data scientist.”

The other girl hummed. “Woah, nice. Maybe I should introduce you to Entrapta, do you know her?”

Adora thought for a moment. “That’s the one with the purple pigtails?”

“Bingo,” Catra said, snapping her fingers. “She’s *hella* into tech. The girl can’t go a second without something electronic around her.”

The two old friends shared eye contact with each other and then laughed. When their laughter faded, they sat in silence, the only noises around them were crickets chirping and the buzz of the lamp humming above them. Adora looked over at Catra who was fidgeting with her nails.

“ 'I look out for you and you look out for me, nothing really bad can happen as long as we have each other.' ”

Catra’s ears perked and she looked over at Adora with wide eyes, only to see that the girl was looking at the ground with an unreadable expression. “How-”

Adora looked up at the girl and gave her a small smile, making the other girl stop mid sentence. “Before you said that I probably forgot the promise we made, that I probably forgot everything about us when I got on that damn plane across the country.” She flashed a smirk. “But I didn’t. Bet you weren’t expecting that weren’t you?”

Rolling her eyes, Catra jabbed Adora in the ribs with her elbow as she huffed under her breath: *Asshole* .

Keeping her eyes on Catra, Adora took a deep breath. "Catra, I'm *so* sorry that when I left I didn't keep in touch with you. I really wanted to, but I couldn't. I didn't know our address to send mail nor your house phone number so I could call you. I couldn't go back and visit because we didn't have the money to afford that just yet, even with Mara's job. But when we did get the money, I was just so busy with school and my own part time job that I forgot. I'm so sorry."

"After I moved, it wasn't the same without you, I missed you so much," Adora continued. "I would always think about you and make up scenarios about you just coming to my door to surprise me. But again, my work consumed me and stress was the only thing bearing on the shoulders that I forgot. Looking back, I hate myself for forgetting about us. When I saw you at Camp Etheria, the camp we went together every summer, I was just so surprised and when you told me we were no longer friends, I was heartbroken, but you had every right to be upset at me. Even now, you don't have to forgive me, I just wanted to give you some closure and tell you that if you are willing to reconnect again, I'll be here waiting."

A moment of silence passed before Catra finally spoke up. "It's okay," she sighed. "I've been thinking about you a lot too when I saw you again after all those years. When you left, you were the only thing I could think about. I tried to not be too sad that you were leaving because I knew that you were going to come back or still talk to me. But I guess I was wrong, so I just felt really betrayed." She crossed her arms. "I missed you every single day, I thought about you every single day, just recently- before camp- I

thought I was finally over you, but when I saw you again, all of my feelings of anger, sorrow, sadness, confusion… and *other* feelings, just came flooding back towards me. That's why I snapped at you like that. I should apologize for yelling at you too, I'm sorry."

"I deserved it," Adora chuckled.

Facing Adora, Catra stared at her. "It's okay- well it hurt before but after a lot of thinking, I understand, you didn't have any power to come back or talk to me. It's tiring to hold a grudge anyway. But I think it just hurt so much because it felt like you betrayed me, especially because I cared for you so much and I hate to say it, but I still do."

Seeing Catra's flushed face just made Adora's cheek turn red. "Oh my gods, you care for me? That's adorable!"

"Shut up!" Catra snapped. "So what if I do, idiot?"

Grinning from ear to ear, Adora embraced Catra in a hug, seeing that she crossed the line, she tried to pull back but was surprised when Catra didn't let her go just yet. "I'm a bit angry that so many years have passed since we have talked to each other and *now* we just reconnect. A bunch of lost time, am I right?" Catra said. "I mean, there's so many things that we didn't get to do together."

Weaving Catra’s hand in hers, Adora smiled at her lovingly. “It’s okay, let’s do it all. Because from now on, there will still be a lot of time for us to spend with each other.”

End Notes

yeah this fanfiction isn't supposed to like show that catra and adora become a couple but it's more like fixing a friendship, but you guys can guess that they get together bc it's highly hinted that they had feelings for each other and their colleges are close to each other so yes they do get together but you guys can think about how they do that. also yeah ronin and ivy were parallels to adora and catra when they were younger. ronin's more of the catra and ivy is more of the adora LOL. anyway yeah my next and last fanfiction is going to be coming out next monday which also happens to be my one year anniversary that i started writing on ao3! i started with writing catradora and i'm going to go a full circle and end it with catradora before going on hiatus. again i'll give out more info on why i'm going to be going on hiatus next week! anyway i hope you guys enjoyed today's fanfiction and feel free to leave a comment and drop a kudos down below and i hope you all have a good morning/afternoon/evening! :)

Please drop by the archive and comment to let the author know if you enjoyed their work!